



5G for neural manufacturing
TCS successfully used Airtel's 5G network to test its neural manufacturing solutions suite. <https://digit.in/jan22-15>



iPhone 14 to get punch hole screen
The iPhone 14 is rumoured to get a punch-hole screen, and ditch the screen notch. <https://digit.in/jan22-16>

Sony WF-1000XM4

An all-rounder like no other

Even though the acclaimed Sony WF-1000XM3 TWS earphones launched in 2020, they continued to reign supreme in our noise-cancelling TWS lists until now. Now that the latest model in Sony's supremely successful WF-1000X lineup – Sony WF-1000XM4 – has finally made its way to India, we have a feeling it may just dethrone its predecessor. Here's how the Sony WF-1000XM4 fared in our review.



BUILD AND COMFORT

Sony went back to the drawing board and completely redesigned the Sony WF-1000XM4. The case is 40 per cent smaller and earbuds are 10 per cent smaller than the Mark 3s.

The earbuds are available in two colours – Black and Silver. The case has a simple matte texture with the Sony logo stamped on top. The magnets inside the case are extremely strong, however, the lid feels a tad flimsy.

The earbuds are more rounded than the Mark 3s and have a circular golden accent around the microphone that adds some flair. The back of the earbuds houses capacitive touch controls, which are reliable and responsive.

Owing to the bulky nature of the earbuds, the Sony WF-1000XM4 is definitely not the most secure pair of earbuds we've worn. But the fit is miles better than the Mark 3s. Sony's new Noise Isolation Earbud foam tips provide a fairly secure fit. The earbuds also come with IPX4 water resistance.

FEATURES

The Sony Headphone Connect app is possibly one of the most utilitarian and versatile companion apps we've ever used with TWS earbuds. The app has a plethora of features and customisation options that give users granular control over the earbuds. You get a 5-band customisable EQ, sound presets, charging status, and customisable controls.

The app allows users to access features such as Adaptive Sound Control, Speak to Chat, 360 Reality Audio, DSEE Extreme, Earbud Fit test, and more. Adaptive Sound Control is a useful feature that uses AI smarts to determine your activity (staying, walking, running, or transport) and applies noise-cancellation accordingly.

One feature we did miss is multi-point connectivity.

PERFORMANCE

Sony headphones are formidable in the ANC category, and the Sony WF-1000XM4 more than lives up to the legacy of Sony noise-cancelling headphones. Active Noise Cancellation on these earbuds is truly exceptional, so much so that it almost matches up the performance of their over-ear noise-cancelling cans! All of this is accomplished by the new Sony V1 processor and dual noise-sensing microphones in each earbud. The earphones easily beat the Jabra Elite 7 Pro and the AirPods Pro when it comes to ANC performance.

Coming to sound, the earphones pack 6mm drivers that produce energetic yet balanced sound. The earphones support the SBC, AAC and LDAC codecs. We tested the earphones on the LDAC codec since it provides

the highest quality of all the available ones. The Sony WF-1000XM4 has dynamic bass response, pristine mids, and decent highs. You get analytical yet energetic bass response that brings out the rumble in the lows while still maintaining clarity and accuracy. We are seriously impressed by how exquisitely detailed the lows are but even more impressed with the mids' clarity. As a result, these headphones are excellent for not only popular genres such as pop, rap, EDM and more but also to listen to classical tunes, podcasts and watch movies. The microphone quality and wireless connectivity is pretty good as well, but not the best we've reviewed.



BATTERY LIFE

Owing to the reduced size, we were expecting the battery life to take a hit in comparison to its predecessor. Fortunately, that's not the case. Along with the charging case, you get 24 hours of total battery life (8 hours on earbuds + 16 hours from charging case),

which is pretty impressive. If you use the earphones with ANC turned off, Sony claims you get 32 hours of total battery life. In our tests, the earbuds themselves lasted 6.5 hours with LDAC and ANC turned on.

VERDICT

There's a reason why Sony's ANC headphone launches are surrounded by so much hype. This company consistently makes some of the best ANC audio devices on the market. The Sony WF-1000XM4 continues that legacy. It is simply one of the best ANC TWS earphones money can buy right now.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.2 | SUPPORTED AUDIO CODECS: SBC, AAC, LDAC | DSEE EXTREME: Yes | DRIVER UNIT SIZE: 6mm | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20Hz-20kHz | BATTERY CHARGE TIME: Approx. 1.5 hrs | BATTERY LIFE: 8 hours (NC On) / 12 hours (NC Off) | IP RATING: IPX4 (earbuds) | CASE WEIGHT: 41g

CONTACT

COMPANY: Sony | PHONE: 18001037799 | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: <https://www.sony.co.in/>